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Site Boundary

Existing Vegetation (Woodland, Hedges and Trees)

Existing Public Footpath and Bridleway

Proposed New Woodland, Hedgerow and Tree Planting

Proposed Green Space

Proposed Allotments

Proposed Sports

Proposed SUDs / Drainage Ditches

Proposed LEAPs

Proposed NEAPs

Final layout and design of the green infrastructure to be reserved, providing significant flexibility to allow the creation of a range of different habitats, the detail of which will be provided in consultation with interested parties including statutory and non-statutory nature conservation organisations

Scale: 1:5000 @ A1

0 100 200 300 400 500m

N

1 Existing ponds – former great crested newt breeding pond.

a. Re-establish more permanent standing water that can be used by amphibians and other wildlife
b. Enhanced through removal of over-shading/encroaching vegetation, willow pollarding and, if necessary, removal of silt and leaflitter in pond base.
c. Instigate sympathetic management regime to maintain suitability for amphibians.

2 Informal open space – existing agricultural land (turf)

a. Enhanced to provide more suitable habitat for amphibians and wildlife in general;
b. Grassland habitat creation using hay meadow seed mix
c. Varied grassland management to include areas of traditional hay meadow management, higher intensity management and areas of low intervention.

3 Informal open space and 'wildlife areas' – existing area of arable land and improved and semi-improved grasslands of low existing interest

a. Enhanced to provide more suitable habitat for wildlife including amphibians, reptile birds and invertebrates;
b. Sward enhancement to diversify existing grassland and increase cover of wildflowers.
c. Potential for green hay application and over-seeding with wildflowers to be investigated where sympathetic management does not deliver desired benefits
d. Excavation of new ponds/reinstate dry ditches where possible and provision of suds drainage to increase available habitat for breeding amphibians
e. Planting of woodland copses and scattered scrub/tree planting to increase habitat diversity, and habitat for wildlife including amphibians breeding birds and invertebrates and as potential as a stepping stone for woodland species through the site.
f. Low intensity hay-meadow management and areas of lower intensity cyclical management.
g. The use of grazing as a management technique to be investigated where practical.

4 New/Suds ponds

a. New ponds shaped to provide a range of bank angles/heights
b. Variations in water depth, including areas of permanent deeper open water, shallows and seasonally dry margins/wet mud
c. Where possible, SUDS will be located close to existing wetland areas, so plants and animals can naturally colonise the new SUDS ponds;
d. Well vegetated shallow bays will be created allowing the establishment of areas of marsh;
e. Smoothly finished surfaces would be avoided; although they give the impression of tidiness they provide less micro habitat diversity for plants and animals; and
f. If planting is essential, such as for the earlier phases, only native plants of local origin will be used.
g. Where possible consideration given to the biodiversity enhancement of the South Marston Brook course as part of the drainage scheme

5 New broad-leaved woodland

a. Woodlands, small groups of trees and individual trees are a vital component of the Wiltshire landscape and would form an important component of the site.
b. A range of woodland types to be planted to include new woodland blocks and small copses, new woodland tree belts and augmentation of existing woodland belts and scattered trees and scrub planting using native species representative of local woodlands
c. The Great Western Community Forest objectives of creating and maintaining a high quality environment for local people by diversifying land-use, enhancing biodiversity and providing new opportunities for leisure, recreation, cultural activity, education, healthy living and social and economic development would be followed where possible.
d. Woodland planting will used to augment existing resource and provide additional enhanced links and stepping-stone habitats for woodland species using Nightingale Wood and other woodlands in the locality

6 Wet grassland

a. Wet grassland habitat created along swales and surface water attenuation lagoons
b. So provide areas of seasonally flooded habitat
c. Seeded with native species tolerant of wetter conditions characteristic of habitat present along the River Cole, South Marston Brook and wetland habitat in Nightingale woodland and adjacent Neutral Grassland SNA

7 New Strategic Amphibian habitats

a. Potential locations for new wetland features to provide strategic locations for new large great crested newt populations, where their translocation is deemed necessary and acheivable.
b. Habitats to include new ponds and surrounding good quality terrestrial habitat including species-rich grassland, woodland copses and patches of scrub.

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Hallam Land Management, Taylor Wimpey & Hannick Homes
East Swindon
Wiltshire

OUTLINE BIODIVERSITY ENHANCEMENT OPTIONS

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masterplanning
environmental assessment
landscape design
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